CONFOEDERATIO,
RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

DEMOGRAPHY AND SETTLEMENT OF EARLY IMPERIAL RUSSIA (1721AD - 1815AD).

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (1721AD - 1815AD).

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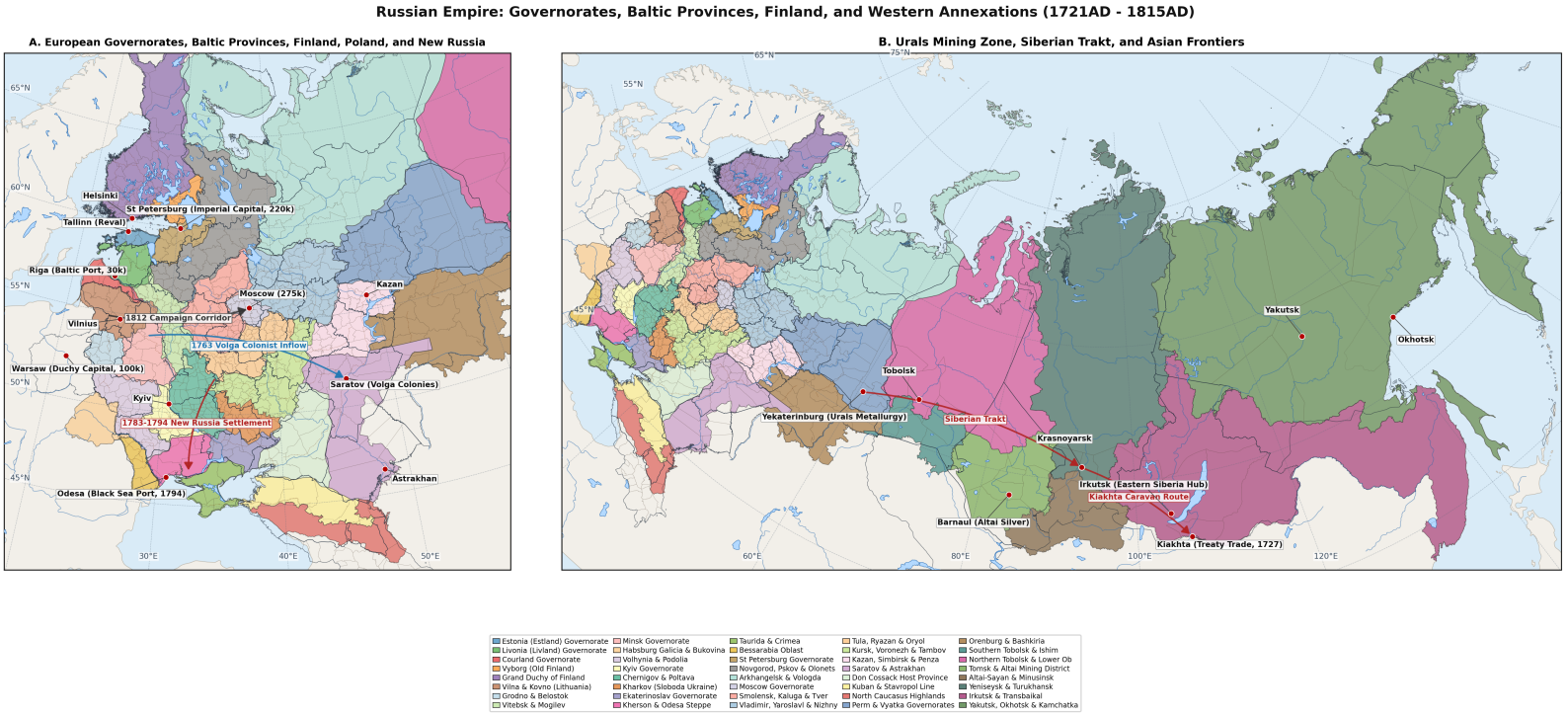


Figure 1. Administrative regions, frontier colonisation corridors, and major cities of Early Imperial Russia and adjacent partition lands (1721AD - 1815AD).

Soul-Revision Sources & Methodology (1721-1815AD)

Between the proclamation of the Russian Empire at the Treaty of Nystad in September 1721AD and the Final Act of the Congress of Vienna in June 1815AD - prior to the formal incorporation of Congress Poland - the territories of the Russian Empire and its contiguous partitioned borderlands underwent one of the largest demographic expansions in early modern Eurasia. Across the 40 period-authentic provincial and frontier regions defined in imperial_russia_pre_1815.json5 (spanning 18 496 636 km^2 and 457 996 raster pixels across the Baltic Baltic governorates, Old Finland and the Grand Duchy of Finland, the Polish-Lithuanian Partition lands including Habsburg Galicia-Bukovina, Left-Bank and Steppe Ukraine, Bessarabia, European Russia, the North Caucasus and eighteenth-century Siberia, whilst excluding Central Asia and Transcaucasia), total population more than doubled from 23 888k (23,89M) in 1721AD to 51 171k (51,17M) in 1815AD (+114,2%) [1][2][3][4]. Within the 39 regions that belonged to the Russian Empire by 1815AD (18 426 024 km^2, excluding Region 10, the Habsburg Kingdom of Galicia and Lodomeria with Bukovina and Carpathian Rus, which grew from 1 625k to 3 350k), the population within the 1815AD

imperial envelope rose from 22 263k (22,26M) in 1721AD to 25 606k in 1744AD, 30 119k in 1762AD, 35 768k in 1782AD, 40 746k in 1795AD, 45 069k in 1806AD, 47 160k on the eve of Napoleon's invasion in 1811AD and 47 821k (47,82M) in 1815AD (+114,8%) [5][6][7]. Taken strictly within contemporary shifting sovereign frontiers, the de facto population ruled from Saint Petersburg expanded nearly threefold from roughly 15,6M at the close of the Great Northern War (1721AD) to 37,4M after the Third Partition of Poland-Lithuania (1795AD) and 43,1M - 47,8M by 1815AD, combining sustained rural natural increase in the forest-steppe and Volga-Ural basins with the annexation of densely settled western and southern provinces [2][8][9].

Quantitative reconstruction across the eight benchmark slices of imperial_russia_pre_1815.json5 (1721AD, 1744AD, 1762AD, 1782AD, 1795AD, 1806AD, 1811AD and 1815AD) rests upon four interlocking archival regimes [10][11]:

Imperial Poll-Tax Soul Revisions (*Revizskie skazki*, Revisions I to VII), instituted by Peter I's decree of 26 November 1718AD to replace the seventeenth-century household tax (*podvornoe oblozhenie*, last enumerated across European Russia in 1678AD and 1710AD) with a capitation levy (*podushnaya podat*) assessed on individual male "revision souls" (*revizskie dushi*), the Imperial Senate and College of Camarilla conducted seven enumerations between 1719AD and 1816AD [10][11][12]. The First Revision (1719-1724AD, verified by military inspection commissions up to 1727AD) and Second Revision (1743-1747AD) registered taxable males only (court, monastic and seigneurial serfs alongside urban *posadskie*), omitting women, hereditary nobles, clergy, regular troops and entire autonomous borderlands (the Ostsee provinces, Left-Bank Hetmanate, Sloboda Cossack regiments and nomadic steppe peoples) [1][3]. Beginning with the Third Revision (1761-1763AD), Fourth Revision (1781-1782AD, synchronised with Catherine II's 1775AD *Guberniya* Statute) and Fifth Revision (1794-1795AD), female inhabitants were recorded alongside males, and fiscal registration was extended across the Ostsee provinces (*Hingeloendid* / *Seelenrevisionen*), Little Russia, Sloboda Ukraine, Novorossiya and the newly annexed Belarusian, Lithuanian and Right-Bank Ukrainian governorates [2][13]. Under wartime fiscal urgency on the eve of the 1812AD campaign, Alexander I's Sixth Revision (decreed 18 May 1811AD) reverted to a rapid male-only count, necessitating sex-ratio parity multipliers derived from the post-war Seventh Revision (decreed 20 June 1815AD and completed in 1816AD), which restored full male-female household schedules and captured the demographic toll of the Napoleonic wars [6][7][14][15]. Following Vladimir Kabuzan, Yaroslav Vodarsky and Boris Mironov, total regional populations are derived from archival Central Statistical Committee and RGADA *perechnevye vedomosti* by doubling male revision souls where female returns were absent (applying empirical regional female-to-male ratios of 1,02 - 1,06), adding non-taxable estates (*nepodayushchie sosloviya*: nobility, Orthodox and Uniate clergy, civil officials, retired soldiers and regular garrisons, typically 4,5% - 7,5% of provincial totals) and correcting early-revision infant and fugitive under-registration (+18% - 22% before military verification in 1721AD, narrowing to +3% - 5% by 1782-1795AD and +6% - 8% during the rushed 1811AD count) [1][16].

Swedish-Finnish *Tabellverket* and Lutheran Parish Registers (Regions 1-5): In the Grand Duchy of Finland (Region 5), continuous national vital and population tabulations began in 1749AD under the Royal Swedish *Tabellverket* - the oldest continuous state demographic statistical office in Europe - preserved unbroken after the 1809AD Treaty of Fredrikshamn [17][18][19]. For 1721AD and 1744AD, Eino Jutikkala, Oiva Turpeinen and Kari Pitkänen reconstructed county populations backward from the 1749AD baseline using Lutheran communion books (*rippikirjat*) and burial registers across the post-1713AD *Isoviha* ("Great Wrath") recovery and the 1741-1743AD Russo-Swedish War [17][20]. In Estland (Region 1), Livland (Region 2) and Courland (Region 3), Heldur Palli and August Wilhelm Hupel cross-checked eighteenth-century *Hakenrevisionen* ploughland rolls (1725-1726AD, 1732AD, 1744AD, 1758AD and 1774AD) against Lutheran parish registers before Imperial Soul Revisions began in 1782AD (and 1795AD in Courland) [13][21][22][23]. In Old Finland / Vyborg Governorate (Region 4), Russian revision rolls from 1724AD and

1744AD supplement Karelian Lutheran church books [24].

Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth Hearth/Poll Censuses and Habsburg Conscriptions (Regions 6-12): Prior to the Three Partitions (1772AD, 1793AD and 1795AD), demographic series across Lithuania, Belarus and Right-Bank Ukraine draw on the 1764-1765AD Commonwealth Jewish capitation census, episcopal Uniate and Roman Catholic parish visitations, Four-Year Sejm hearth taxes (*podymne*, 1789-1790AD) and magnate estate inventories synthesised by Cezary Kuklo, Shaul Stampfer and Arnold Perkovsky [25][26][27][28]. In Region 10 (Habsburg Galicia and Bukovina), Vienna introduced military-fiscal soul conscriptions immediately upon annexation in 1772-1776AD, followed by Emperor Joseph II's patent conscriptions of 1785-1787AD and Franciscan updates of 1807-1815AD [29][30].

Cossack Regimental Surveys, Steppe Cadastral Rolls and Siberian *Yasak* Books (Regions 13-18, 29-31 and 34-40): In the Left-Bank Hetmanate (Region 13) and Sloboda Ukraine (Region 14), regimental *revizii* of 1723-1732AD and Field Marshal Pyotr Rumyantsev's monumental General Description of Little Russia (*Generalnaya opis Malorossii*, 1765-1769AD) bridge the pre-1782AD gap [31][32][33]. Across Novorossiya, Crimea and Bessarabia (Regions 15-18), Ottoman *tahrir* / *cizye* estimates, the 1783-1784AD Taurida cameral description of Baron Osip Igelström, Apollon Skalkovsky's Novorossiya chancellery tables and the 1812-1816AD Bessarabian boyar and colonist surveys anchor rapid frontier settlement [34][35][36][37]. In the North Caucasus highlands (Region 31) and Siberia (Regions 34-40), Russian revision books for Slavic peasants, *pripisnye* mineworkers and Siberian Tatars are combined with *yasak* fur-tribute ledgers and Gerhard Friedrich Müller's academic expedition questionnaires [5][38][39][40].

Figure 2 illustrates the aggregate imperial trajectory alongside ten contrasting provincial curves, whilst Table 1 presents the complete 40-region series from _gis_cache/imperial_russia_pre_1815_summary.json and Table 2 summarises the seven Imperial Soul Revisions and parallel borderland enumerations.

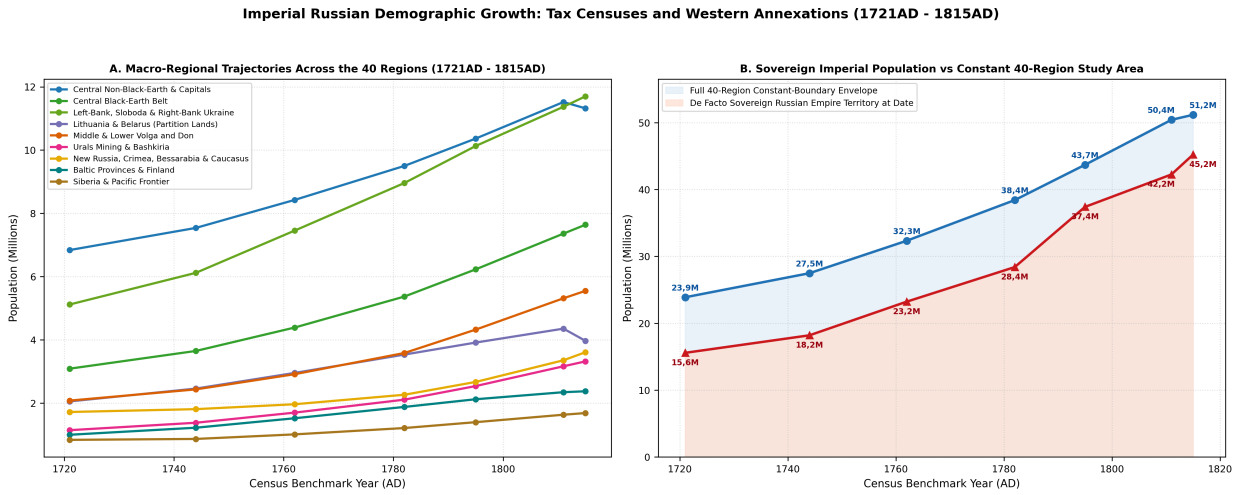


Figure 2. Total population growth across Early Imperial Russia (Panel A) and indexed regional trajectories relative to 1721AD = 100 (1721AD - 1815AD, Panel B).

Period-Authentic Region (1-40)	1721AD	1744AD	1762AD	1782AD	1795AD	1806AD	1811AD	1815AD	Change
1. Estland Governorate	105k	140k	175k	200k	212k	222k	228k	232k	+121,0%
2. Livland Governorate	195k	280k	385k	495k	550k	585k	605k	615k	+215,4%

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Period-Authentic Region (1-40)	1721AD	1744AD	1762AD	1782AD	1795AD	1806AD	1811AD	1815AD	Change
3. Courland Governorate	200k	250k	305k	365k	405k	425k	435k	418k	+109,0%
4. Old Finland / Vyborg Governorate	110k	128k	152k	175k	186k	194k	198k	202k	+83,6%
5. Grand Duchy of Finland	390k	425k	505k	645k	770k	875k	880k	908k	+132,8%
6. Vilna Governorate & Samogitia / Kovno	655k	760k	880k	1 020k	1 110k	1 190k	1 220k	1 110k	+69,5%
7. Grodno Governorate & Belostok Oblast	360k	430k	515k	615k	680k	735k	760k	695k	+93,1%
8. Vitebsk & Mogilev Governorates	610k	740k	910k	1 110k	1 240k	1 340k	1 380k	1 245k	+104,1%
9. Minsk Governorate & Pripyat Polesia	430k	530k	650k	790k	885k	960k	995k	920k	+114,0%
10. Habsburg Kingdom of Galicia & Lodomeria	1 625k	1 880k	2 220k	2 650k	2 950k	3 160k	3 260k	3 350k	+106,2%
11. Volhynia & Podolia Governorates	1 195k	1 490k	1 880k	2 300k	2 600k	2 780k	2 870k	2 960k	+147,7%
12. Kyiv Governorate	342k	430k	550k	655k	755k	855k	905k	940k	+174,9%
13. Little Russia: Chernigov & Poltava Governorates	1 555k	1 820k	2 180k	2 580k	2 920k	3 160k	3 270k	3 350k	+115,4%
14. Sloboda-Ukrainian / Kharkov Governorate	402k	500k	625k	775k	905k	1 010k	1 065k	1 100k	+173,6%
15. Ekaterinoslav Governorate & Former Zaporozhian Lands	145k	175k	225k	355k	540k	690k	765k	820k	+465,5%
16. Kherson / Nikolaev Governorate & Ochakov Steppe	105k	125k	155k	225k	355k	495k	565k	620k	+490,5%
17. Taurida Governorate	370k	350k	345k	320k	260k	315k	345k	370k	0,0%
18. Bessarabia Oblast	200k	225k	255k	290k	320k	340k	310k	385k	+92,5%
19. Saint Petersburg Governorate	260k	345k	435k	545k	625k	695k	735k	760k	+192,3%

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Period-Authentic Region (1-40)	1721AD	1744AD	1762AD	1782AD	1795AD	1806AD	1811AD	1815AD	Change
20. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Governorates	1 155k	1 250k	1 365k	1 510k	1 625k	1 715k	1 755k	1 770k	+53,2%
21. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Governorates	560k	610k	670k	750k	820k	875k	905k	920k	+64,3%
22. Moscow Governorate	725k	795k	885k	985k	1 085k	1 185k	1 235k	1 120k	+54,5%
23. Smolensk, Kaluga & Tver Governorates	1 720k	1 890k	2 110k	2 380k	2 590k	2 780k	2 870k	2 640k	+53,5%
24. Central Non-Black-Earth Governorates: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma & Nizhny Novgorod	2 420k	2 650k	2 960k	3 330k	3 620k	3 890k	4 020k	4 110k	+69,8%
25. Northern Central Black-Earth Governorates: Tula, Ryazan & Oryol	1 580k	1 830k	2 150k	2 580k	2 950k	3 260k	3 420k	3 520k	+122,8%
26. Southern Central Black-Earth Governorates: Kursk, Voronezh & Tambov	1 510k	1 820k	2 240k	2 790k	3 280k	3 710k	3 940k	4 120k	+172,8%
27. Middle Volga Governorates: Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	1 420k	1 660k	1 960k	2 360k	2 720k	3 020k	3 180k	3 290k	+131,7%
28. Saratov & Astrakhan Governorates	480k	560k	690k	860k	1 120k	1 360k	1 490k	1 580k	+229,2%
29. Province of the Don Cossack Host	180k	215k	265k	365k	485k	590k	645k	680k	+277,8%
30. Caucasian Fortified Line, Black Sea Cossack Kuban	120k	135k	155k	215k	310k	410k	465k	505k	+320,8%
31. North Caucasian Highlanders: Circassia, Kabarda, Chechnya & Dagestan Khanates	780k	800k	830k	860k	885k	900k	905k	910k	+16,7%
32. Perm & Vyatka Governorates	685k	830k	1 030k	1 290k	1 530k	1 740k	1 845k	1 920k	+180,3%

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Period-Authentic Region (1-40)	1721AD	1744AD	1762AD	1782AD	1795AD	1806AD	1811AD	1815AD	Change
33. Orenburg Governorate & Bashkiria	460k	550k	670k	820k	1 010k	1 210k	1 320k	1 400k	+204,3%
34. Tobolsk Governorate South: Siberian Trakt	215k	255k	308k	380k	445k	500k	528k	545k	+153,5%
35. Tobolsk & Narym River North: Tobolsk, Berezov, Surgut & Obdorsk Yasak Tundra	85k	96k	109k	124k	139k	151k	156k	160k	+88,2%
36. Tomsk Governorate	95k	118k	150k	196k	236k	272k	289k	300k	+215,8%
37. Altai-Sayan & Minusinsk Borderlands	75k	74k	82k	95k	106k	117k	122k	125k	+66,7%
38. Yeniseisk Province: Krasnoyarsk Trakt, Angara Portage & Turukhansk Polar North	72k	76k	86k	102k	118k	132k	138k	144k	+100,0%
39. Irkutsk Governorate & Transbaikal Frontier	142k	134k	152k	181k	209k	232k	243k	252k	+77,5%
40. Yakutsk, Okhotsk Seaboard & Kamchatka Oblast	155k	115k	125k	135k	145k	154k	158k	160k	+3,2%
Sub-Total: Baltic Provinces & Finland (Regions 1-5)	1 000k	1 223k	1 522k	1 880k	2 123k	2 301k	2 346k	2 375k	+137,5%
Sub-Total: Partitions & Galicia-Bukovina (Regions 6-12)	5 217k	6 260k	7 605k	9 140k	10 220k	11 020k	11 390k	11 220k	+115,1%
Sub-Total: Hetmanate, Novorossiya & Bessarabia (Regions 13-18)	2 777k	3 195k	3 785k	4 545k	5 300k	6 010k	6 320k	6 645k	+139,3%
Sub-Total: Capitals, North & Central Russia (Regions 19-26)	9 930k	11 190k	12 815k	14 870k	16 595k	18 110k	18 880k	18 960k	+90,9%

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Period-Authentic Region (1-40)	1721AD	1744AD	1762AD	1782AD	1795AD	1806AD	1811AD	1815AD	Change
Sub-Total: Volga, Urals, Don & Caucasus (Regions 27-33)	4 125k	4 750k	5 600k	6 770k	8 060k	9 230k	9 850k	10 285k	+149,3%
Sub-Total: Siberia & North Pacific (Regions 34-40)	839k	868k	1 012k	1 213k	1 398k	1 558k	1 634k	1 686k	+101,0%
Sub-Total: 39-Region Imperial Envelope (Excl. Reg. 10)	22 263k	25 606k	30 119k	35 768k	40 746k	45 069k	47 160k	47 821k	+114,8%
Grand Total: All 40 Regions (18 496 636 km2)	23 888k	27 486k	32 339k	38 418k	43 696k	48 229k	50 420k	51 171k	+114,2%

Table 1. Population Trajectories across the 40 Period-Authentic Soul-Revision Regions of Early Imperial Russia and Adjacent Partition Lands (1721AD - 1815AD).

Enumeration / Archival Regime	Benchmark	Registered Scope & Sex Coverage	40-Region Total	Standard Scholarly Adjustments
1st Soul Revision (Decreed Nov 1718AD; Verified 1719-1727AD)	1721AD	Taxable males only in Great Russia & Siberia; excludes Ostsee, Hetmanate, nobles	23 888k (22 263k Imp.)	+18-22% early evasion fixed by 1722-1727AD military commissions; x2 sex multiplier + exempted estates
2nd Soul Revision (Decreed Dec 1743AD; Conducted 1744-1747AD)	1744AD	Taxable males only; adds Old Finland (1743AD Abo) & Orenburg Line settlements	27 486k (25 606k Imp.)	+6-9% frontier evasion; x2,03 sex multiplier + clergy/garrisons (Kabuzan 1963; Vodarsky 1973)
3rd Soul Revision (Decreed Nov 1761AD; Conducted 1762-1763AD)	1762AD	Both sexes; still excludes Baltic Ritterschaften & Polish-Lithuanian lands	32 339k (30 119k Imp.)	+4-6% omission; supplemented by 1765-1769AD Rumyantsev Little Russian Survey
4th Soul Revision (Decreed Nov 1781AD; Conducted 1781-1782AD)	1782AD	Both sexes across Catherine II's 1775AD namestnichestva, Ostsee, Hetmanate, E. Belarus	38 418k (35 768k Imp.)	+3-4% omission; unified cameral accounting across 41 vicegerencies (Kabuzan 1971)
5th Soul Revision (Decreed Jun 1794AD; Conducted 1794-1795AD)	1795AD	Both sexes across 50 provinces incl. 2nd/3rd Polish Partitions, Courland & Crimea	43 696k (40 746k Imp.)	+3-5% omission (+10-15% in newly annexed Jewish kahal rolls; Stampfer 1995)

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Enumeration / Archival Regime	Benchmark	Registered Scope & Sex Coverage	40-Region Total	Standard Scholarly Adjustments
Governorate Annual Tables & 1806AD Administrative Returns	1806AD	Both sexes via Ministry of Internal Affairs provincial reports & Keppen tables	48 229k (45 069k Imp.)	Reconciled with diocesan vital balances (CBR 48-51, CDR 33-37 per 1 000; Hermann 1819)
6th Soul Revision (Decreed May 1811AD; Wartime Male Count)	1811AD	Males only under pre-war fiscal urgency; includes Belostok (1807) & Finland (1809)	50 420k (47 160k Imp.)	Female parity interpolated from 5th/7th Revisions; +6-8% hurried wartime undercount (Keppen 1857)
7th Soul Revision (Decreed Jun 1815AD; Conducted 1815-1816AD)	1815AD	Both sexes across post-Vienna Empire incl. Bessarabia (1812AD); captures 1812 losses	51 171k (47 821k Imp.)	Direct measurement of 1812-1814AD excess military/civilian deficits in Regions 3, 6-9, 22-23
Parallel Borderland Censuses (Tabellverket, Commonwealth, Habsburg)	1721-1815AD	Swedish-Finnish Tabellverket (from 1749AD), 1764/1789 Polish rolls, Austrian conscriptions	Anchored in Regions 1-12	Palli (1996), Jutikkala (1965), Kuklo (2009) & Bohachevsky (1967) parish-census syntheses

Table 2. Imperial Fiscal Revisions (I-VII) and Parallel Borderland Demographic Sources Anchoring the Eight Benchmark Slices (1721AD - 1815AD).

Baltic Provinces and Finland (Regions 1-5)

Across the northwestern Baltic littoral (Regions 1-5, 481 891 km^2), combined population grew by +137,5% from 1 000k in 1721AD to 2 375k in 1815AD under institutional regimes wholly distinct from Great Russian serfdom [9][13][17]. Under the Capitulations of Riga and Reval (1710AD), confirmed at the Treaty of Nystad (30 August 1721AD), Peter I guaranteed the Baltic German *Ritterschaften*, Lutheran consistories and Hanseatic magistrate privileges of Estland Governorate (Region 1) and Livland Governorate (Region 2, including Ösel/Saaremaa and South Estonian Dorpat-Pernau alongside Latvian Vidzeme) [21][41]. Both provinces entered 1721AD severely depleted by the Great Famine of 1695-1697AD, Great Northern War devastation and the catastrophic 1710-1711AD Baltic bubonic plague, which had killed over half the inhabitants of Reval (Tallinn) and Riga: Estland stood at just 105k in 1721AD and Livland at 195k [13][22]. Over the next six decades, the absence of Russian military conscription (until 1797AD), early smallpox variolation, Moravian Brethren (*Herrnhuter*) peasant literacy campaigns and grain-distilling manor expansion fuelled one of Europe's fastest post-plague recoveries [13][23]. Estland more than doubled to 175k (1762AD), 212k (1795AD) and 232k (1815AD, +121,0%), with Reval rising from 5,2k to 12,8k alongside Wesenberg, Hapsal and Weissenstein. Livland more than tripled from 195k (1721AD) to 385k (1762AD), 550k (1795AD) and 615k (1815AD, +215,4%), led by Riga - the Empire's second maritime export port after Saint Petersburg - which expanded from 11,8k in 1721AD to 36,5k in 1811AD (dipping slightly to 36,0k in 1815AD after Governor Essen burned Riga's wooden suburbs against Marshal Macdonald's X Corps in July 1812AD), whilst Dorpat (Tartu, refounded as an Imperial German-language university in 1802AD) grew from 1,8k to 7,5k and Narva, Pernau, Fellin, Walk and Arensburg anchored coastal and inland trade

[21][23]. Alexander I's 1804AD Livland and Estland peasant ordinances regulated corvée (*Fronarbeit*) norms and prepared the full personal emancipation enacted in 1816-1819AD [4].

To the south, the Duchy of Courland and Semigallia (Region 3, together with Pilten District) remained a Polish-Lithuanian vassal fief under the Kettler and Biron dukes until its annexation during the Third Partition in March 1795AD [5][9]. Spared the worst fighting of 1710-1721AD, Courland grew steadily from 200k in 1721AD to 305k (1762AD), 405k at the Fifth Revision (1795AD) and 435k in 1811AD, centred on the ducal capital of Mitau (Jelgava, 5,5k -> 12,0k), the ice-free Baltic port of Libau (Liepaja, 2,8k -> 6,2k), Windau (Ventspils), Goldingen and Bauske. In 1812AD, Franco-Prussian occupation, cattle requisitions and typhus reduced Courland's population to 418k by the Seventh Revision (1815AD, +109,0% overall) [6].

Across the Gulf of Finland, Karelian and Finnish territories entered the Empire in two stages:

Old Finland / Vyborg Governorate (Region 4: 110k to 202k, +83,6%): Ceded by Sweden in two slices - Karelian Vyborg and Kexholm at Nystad (1721AD) and the Kymi River strip of Hamina (Fredrikshamn), Lappeenranta (Villmanstrand) and Savonlinna (Nyslott) at the Treaty of Åbo (1743AD) - Vyborg Governorate grew from 110k (1721AD) to 152k (1762AD) and 198k (1811AD) [24]. Unlike mainland Sweden-Finland, vast tracts of Old Finland were granted as imperial *lahjoitusmaat* ("donation estates") to Russian court aristocrats, depressing peasant mobility relative to Swedish Savo-Karelia until Alexander I reunited Vyborg Governorate with the autonomous Grand Duchy of Finland on 1 January 1812AD (reaching 202k in 1815AD, with Vyborg town at 3,8k alongside Sortavala, Kexholm and Hamina) [17][24].

Grand Duchy of Finland (Region 5: 390k to 908k, +132,8%): Emerging from the demographic trough of the 1713-1721AD Russian occupation (*Isoviha*, 390k in 1721AD) and the 1741-1743AD *Pikkuviha* war (425k in 1744AD), mainland Finland experienced rapid pioneering land clearance (*isojaot* enclosure, tar-burning in Ostrobothnia and slash-and-burn *kaski* farming in Savonia), surging across the *Tabellverket* registers to 505k (1762AD), 645k (1782AD), 770k (1795AD) and 875k (1806AD) [17][18]. During the Finnish War of 1808-1809AD, epidemic dysentery, typhus and relapsing fever spread along military supply routes, pushing Finland's crude death rate above 55 - 60 per 1 000 in 1808-1809AD and causing roughly 35k - 45k excess civilian deaths [19][20]. Consequently, Region 5 plateaued at 880k in 1811AD after annexation under the Diet of Borgå (Porvoo) and Treaty of Fredrikshamn (17 September 1809AD), before rebounding to 908k by 1815AD. In April 1812AD, Alexander I transferred the Grand Duchy's capital from Swedish-oriented Åbo (Turku, Finland's largest town at 11,6k in 1815AD) to Helsingfors (Helsinki, 4,8k, guarded by Sveaborg sea fortress), alongside Uleåborg (Oulu, 3,8k), Vasa (9k), Björneborg (Pori, 2,8k) and Tammerfors (Tampere) [17].

Polish Partitions, Early Pale & Galicia (Regions 6-12)

The geopolitical centrepiece of Catherine II's western policy was the tripartite dismemberment of the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth (1772AD, 1793AD and 1795AD), augmented by Napoleon's cession of Belostok (Bialystok) Oblast to Russia at the Treaty of Tilsit (July 1807AD) [9][25][42]. Across Regions 6-12 (553 379 km^2), combined population rose by +115,1% from 5 217k in 1721AD to a pre-war peak of 11 390k in 1811AD before contracting to 11 220k in 1815AD under the devastation of the 1812AD campaign in Lithuania and Belarus (Table 3).

Chronology & Event	Primary Regions	Demographic Magnitude & Structural Impact	Key Literature
1721AD Nystad & 1743AD Abo Treaties (Baltic & Old Finland)	Regions 1, 2 & 4	Incorporates 410k inhabitants (1721AD) + 55k (1743AD); rapid post-1710 plague rebound	Palli 1996; Kashchenko 2016

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Chronology & Event	Primary Regions	Demographic Magnitude & Structural Impact	Key Literature
1762-1766AD Foreign Colonist Manifestos (Volga Germans)	Region 28 (Saratov)	27k-30k German colonists settled in 104 Volga colonies (1764-1768AD), reaching 62k by 1815AD	Bartlett 1979; Galperina 2013
1768-1769AD Kamchatka & Okhotsk Smallpox Pandemic	Region 40 (Kamchatka)	Kills 5 000-6 000 Itelmen/Koryaks (50-65% of Peninsula natives); Reg. 40 held at 125k-135k	Turaev 2012; Tolkacheva 2015
1770-1772AD Russian Plague & Sep 1771AD Moscow Plague Riot	Regions 12, 22, 23 & 25	56k-70k dead in Moscow city (100k+ in Moscow & central uezds); temporary flight halves city	Alexander 1980; Iskhakov 2013
Jan 1771AD Torghut Kalmyk Exodus (*Pylnyy pokhod*)	Region 28 (Astrakhan)	31k-33k tents (150k-170k Kalmyks) depart east of Volga; >85k perish en route to Qing Ili	Khodarkovsky 1992; Ochirov 2012
1772AD, 1793AD & 1795AD Partitions + 1807AD Belostok	Regions 3 & 6-12	Transfers 7,3M Commonwealth subjects to Russia (Regs 3, 6-9, 11-12) & 2,65M to Austria (Reg 10)	Kabuzan 1990; Kuklo 2009; Klier 1986
1773-1775AD Pugachev Rebellion (Yaik, Orenburg, Volga, Urals)	Regions 27, 28, 32 & 33	25k-40k military/civilian deaths; burning of 60+ Ural foundries & Bashkir frontier forts	Kahan 1985; Shaykhislamov 2018
1774-1792AD Novorossiya, 1778AD Mariupol Greeks & 1783AD Crimea	Regions 15, 16, 17 & 30	31k Crimean Christians to Mariupol (1778); 100k-180k Tatars emigrate; >600k colonists arrive	Kabuzan 1976; Williams 2001; Pakhomenko 2014
1808-1809AD Finnish War & Sep 1809AD Fredrikshamn Annexation	Regions 4 & 5	35k-45k war-epidemic deaths in Finland; transfers 880k inhabitants into autonomous Grand Duchy	Jutikkala 1965; Pitkanen 1993
May 1812AD Treaty of Bucharest (Bessarabia Oblast Annexation)	Region 18 (Bessarabia)	Annexes 47 077 km2 (310k in 1811AD -> 385k in 1815AD) via Bulgarian, Gagauz & Moldavian inflows	Feldman 2023; Bas 2015
Jun-Dec 1812AD Patriotic War (Grande Armee Invasion & Retreat)	Regions 3, 6-9, 22 & 23	500k-650k net civilian/military deficit across Lithuania-Belarus (-380k) & Smolensk-Moscow (-345k)	Lieven 2009; Shelomentseva 2015; Kabuzan 1992

Table 3. Major Territorial Annexations, Colonisation Programmes, Epidemic Crises and Wartime Demographic Shocks (1721AD - 1815AD).

Within the partitioned Commonwealth territories, four distinct sub-regional trajectories emerged:

First Partition Eastern Belarus (Vitebsk and Mogilev Governorates, Region 8: 610k to 1 380k in 1811AD to 1 245k in 1815AD, +104,1%): Annexed by Russia in August 1772AD (initially organised as Pskov/Polotsk and Mogilev governorates alongside Polish *Inflanty* / Latgale around Dünaburg/Daugavpils, then briefly merged as Belarus Governorate in 1796-1802AD), Region 8 doubled from 610k (1721AD) to 1 110k at the

Fourth Revision (1782AD) and 1 380k in 1811AD [2][43]. Dense networks of magnate *miasteczka* (*shtetlekh*) such as Shklov, Orsha, Mstislavl and Polotsk joined Vitebsk (5k in 1811AD) and Mogilev (0k in 1811AD) [26][28]. Between June and November 1812AD, however, Region 8 formed the main operational corridor for both the French advance and the catastrophic Berezina retreat (Borisov, Orsha, Vitebsk), suffering acute requisition famine and typhus that cut its Seventh Revision population by -135k (-9,8%) to 1 245k in 1815AD [6][42].

Lithuania, Grodno-Belostok and Central Belarus (Regions 6, 7 and 9): Region 6 (Vilna Governorate and Samogitia/Kovno), annexed in the Third Partition (1795AD), grew from 655k (1721AD) to 1 110k (1795AD) and 1 220k (1811AD), anchored by Vilna (Vilnius) - the largest city of the former Grand Duchy of Lithuania, rising from 19,5k (1721AD) to 42,0k (1811AD) around its Imperial University (rechartered 1803AD) and great Jewish *kahal* - alongside Kovno (Kaunas), Shavli (Siauliai), Rossieny and Troki [25][26]. In June - December 1812AD, Vilna served as Napoleon's rear logistics base and the graveyard of tens of thousands of freezing *Grande Armée* stragglers and typhus-stricken townspeople: Vilna city fell from 42,0k to 36,0k and Region 6 lost -110k (-9,0%) between 1811AD and 1815AD (returning to 1 110k) [6][42]. Region 7 (Grodno Governorate and Belostok Oblast, 1795AD and 1807AD Tilsit) expanded from 360k (1721AD) to 760k (1811AD) before dropping by -8,6% to 695k in 1815AD (centred on Grodno, Belostok, Brest-Litovsk, Slonim, Novogrudok and Lida), whilst Region 9 (Minsk Governorate and Pripyat Polesia, 1793AD Second Partition) grew from 430k (1721AD) to 995k (1811AD) and dropped by -7,5% to 920k in 1815AD after fighting around Minsk, Borisov, Bobruisk fortress, Slutsk and Pinsk [6][43].

Right-Bank Ukraine and the Early Pale of Permanent Jewish Settlement (Regions 11 and 12): Following the Eighteenth-Century *Haidamak* uprisings (*Koliivshchyna*, 1768AD, centred on Uman) and Polish aristocratic *slobody* colonisation across the Podolian-Volhynian forest-steppe, the Second (1793AD) and Third (1795AD) Partitions brought Region 11 (Volhynia and Podolia Governorates: 1 195k to 2 960k, +147,7%) and Right-Bank Region 12 (Kyiv Governorate, uniting Russian Left-Bank Kyiv city and Vasilkov with the annexed Right-Bank interior: 342k to 940k, +174,9%) into the Empire [27][33]. Spared direct occupation by Napoleon's main army in 1812AD (beyond Tormasov's defensive operations on the western Volhynian fringe), Volhynia-Podolia and Kyiv continued growing between 1811AD and 1815AD (2 870k to 2 960k and 905k to 940k), led by Kyiv (8k to 23,4k), Berdichev (0k, hub of Volhynian banking and Hasidic commerce), Kamenets-Podolskiy (6k), Dubno, Zhitomir, Starokonstantinov, Uman (6k), Belaya Tserkov and Cherkassy [27][44]. To prevent Jewish merchants registered in the annexed western *kahals* from competing with Christian guilds in Moscow and interior Great Russia, Catherine II's decree of 23 December 1791AD and Alexander I's *Jewish Statute* (*Polozhenie o evreyakh*) of 9 December 1804AD institutionalised the Pale of Permanent Jewish Settlement (*Cherta postoyannoy evreyskoy osedlosti*) across Lithuania, Belarus, Right-Bank and Left-Bank Ukraine and Novorossiya (encompassing roughly 750k - 900k Jewish inhabitants by 1806-1815AD), whilst Catherine II's 1794-1796AD missionary campaigns transferred roughly 1,5M Right-Bank and Belarusian Greek Catholics (Uniates) to the Russian Orthodox Church [26][28][45].

Habsburg Kingdom of Galicia and Lodomeria, Bukovina and Carpathian Rus (Region 10: 1 625k to 3 350k, +106,2%): Retained within imperial_russia_pre_1815.json5 to ensure seamless spatial continuity with adjacent Commonwealth partition zones and twentieth-century Ukrainian masks (save for the brief 1809-1815AD Russian possession of the Tarnopol Circle ceded at Schönbrunn and returned at Vienna), Habsburg Eastern Galicia (annexed 1772AD), Bukovina (ceded by the Ottoman Empire in 1775AD) and Hungarian Subcarpathian Rus doubled from 1 625k (1721AD) to 2 650k under the Josephine conscriptions (1782AD benchmark) and 3 350k in 1815AD [29][30]. Provincial capital Lemberg / Lviv expanded from 25,0k (1721AD) to 44,5k (1815AD) - making it the third largest city in the entire 40-region study area - alongside the duty-free border entrepôt of Brody (5k to 19,5k), Tarnopol (5k), Stanislawow, Drohobycz, Przemyśl, Czernowitz / Chernivtsi (8k to 6,2k) and Ungvár / Uzhhorod [25][30].

Hetmanate, Novorossiya & Bessarabia (Regions 13-18)

No macro-zone of eighteenth-century Europe experienced a more dramatic transformation of political geography and rural density than the Ukrainian forest-steppe and Pontic littoral (Regions 13-18, 417 427 km^2), which expanded by +139,3% from 2 777k in 1721AD to 6 645k in 1815AD [33][35][46]. Figure 3 displays the structural growth rankings and macro-regional share shifts across the 40 regions.

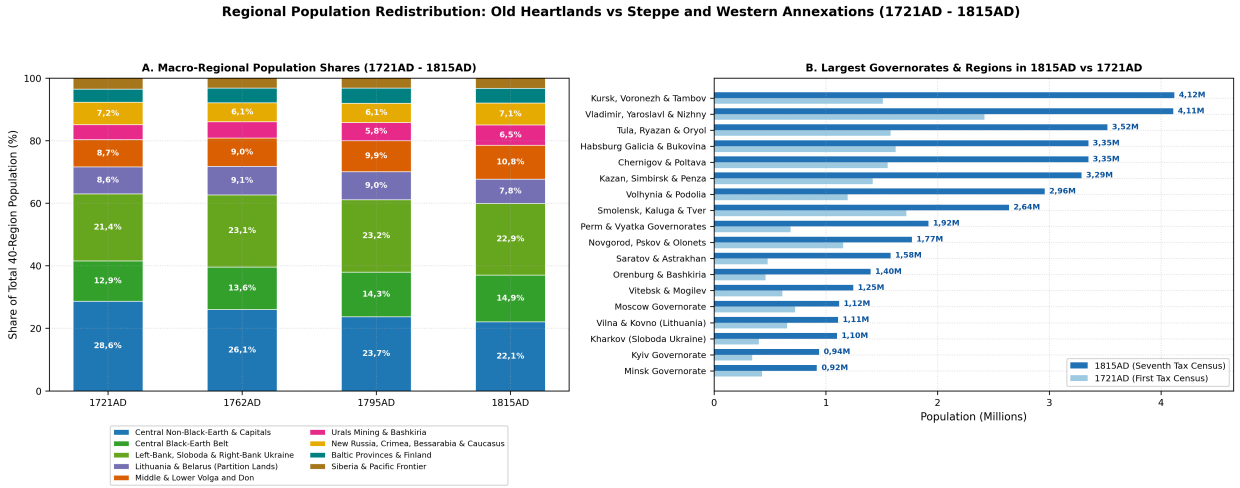


Figure 3. Fastest-growing frontier and capital provinces by percentage gain (Panel A) and macro-regional population shares across tax revisions (1721AD - 1815AD, Panel B).

In the old Ukrainian Cossack lands, imperial centralisation dismantled autonomous regimental governance and folded the population into the regular poll-tax and serf system:

Little Russia (Chernigov and Poltava Governorates, Region 13: 1 555k to 3 350k, +115,4%) and Sloboda Ukraine (Kharkov Governorate, Region 14: 402k to 1 100k, +173,6%): Catherine II abolished the five Sloboda Cossack regiments in July 1765AD (creating Sloboda-Ukrainian Governorate around Kharkov, where Vasily Karazin founded Kharkov Imperial University in 1804-1805AD, growing from 6,2k in 1721AD to 13,5k in 1815AD alongside Sumy, Akhtyrka, Izyum and Belopolye) [32]. In Left-Bank Little Russia, the office of Hetman Kirill Razumovsky was abolished in November 1764AD, Rumyantsev's General Survey enumerated Cossack and peasant households in 1765-1769AD, regimental administration gave way to vicegerencies in 1781AD and the decree of 3 May 1783AD prohibited peasant movement, legally binding Left-Bank *pospoliti* peasants to the Cossack *starshina* (ennobled in 1785AD), whilst registered *vyborni* and *pidpomoshchniki* Little Russian Cossacks survived as a large free smallholder estate [31][47]. Dense agrarian settlement pushed Region 13 to 3 350k (4 inhabitants per km^2) by 1815AD around Nezhin (5k, privileged Greek merchant colony), Poltava (2k), Chernigov, Glukhov, Kremenchug, Starodub and Baturin [33].

South of the forest-steppe, Russo-Ottoman victories transformed the sparsely inhabited "Wild Field" (*Dikoe pole*) and Crimean Khanate into Novorossiya ("New Russia") and Bessarabia [34][46][48]:

Ekaterinoslav Governorate (Region 15: 145k to 820k, +465,5%) and Kherson / Ochakov Steppe (Region 16: 105k to 620k, +490,5%): Colonisation began in the 1750s with Empress Elizabeth's military settlements of New Serbia (1752AD, anchored by Fort Saint Elizabeth / Elisavetgrad) and Slavo-Serbia (1753AD, around Bakhmut and Lugansk foundry, established 1795AD), which absorbed Serbian, Vlach, Bulgarian and Ukrainian settlers despite destructive Crimean Tatar raids such as Khan Qirim Giray's January 1769AD

incursion [35][49]. Following the Treaty of Küçük Kaynarca (July 1774AD), Catherine II ordered General Pyotr Tekeli to surround and abolish the Zaporozhian Sich in June 1775AD, redistributing vast steppe estates under Prince Grigory Potemkin's vicegerency [48][50]. After the Treaty of Jassy (January 1792AD, Old Style December 1791AD) extended Russian rule across the Yedisan / Ochakov steppe between the Southern Bug and Dniester, state peasants, fugitive Great Russian and Ukrainian serfs, Chortitza (1789AD) and Molotschna (1804AD) Prussian Mennonites, Black Sea German Lutheran/Catholic colonists (Liebental, Kutschurgan), Ottoman Bulgarians and Greeks poured into Regions 15 and 16 [51][52][53]. A planned hierarchy of ports and administrative capitals sprang up almost ex nihilo: Kherson (founded 1778AD as Black Sea shipyard, 12,8k in 1815AD), Mariupol (founded 1778-1780AD by ~31k Crimean Rumelian and Urum Greeks relocated from the Crimean Khanate under Metropolitan Ignatios to weaken the Khanate's tax base) [54], Ekaterinoslav (Dnipro, refounded on the Dnieper right bank in 1787AD, 8,2k in 1815AD), Nikolaev (Admiralty dockyard founded 1789AD, 10,5k) and above all Odessa (decreed May 1794AD on the site of Ottoman Khadzhibey), which under Duc de Richelieu's governorship (1803-1814AD) and Mediterranean wheat exports exploded from 1,1k (1782AD) and 4,5k (1795AD) to 35,0k in 1815AD [53][55].

Taurida Governorate / Crimea and Northern Tavria (Region 17: 370k in 1721AD to 260k in 1795AD to 370k in 1815AD, 0,0% net): Alone among the 40 regions, Taurida exhibited a pronounced V-shaped demographic trough across the late eighteenth century [36][56]. Weakened by Russian invasions (1736-1738AD and 1771AD), the 1778AD departure of ~31k Crimean Greeks and Armenians [54] and Catherine II's unilateral annexation of the Crimean Khanate on 8 April 1783AD, between 100k and 180k Crimean Tatars and Nogais emigrated by sea and across the Danube to Ottoman Dobruja and Anatolia between 1783AD and 1793AD [36][56]. Consequently, Region 17 contracted from ~370k (1721AD) and 320k (1782AD) to a Fifth Revision low of 260k in 1795AD, with the old Giray capital of Bakhchisarai shrinking from 14,0k (1721AD) to 6,8k (1795AD) and Karasubazar from 10,5k to 6,2k. Between 1795AD and 1815AD, state peasant settlement in mainland Melitopol-Dnieper uezds, Nogai pacification on the Molochnaya steppe, German/Bulgarian colonies and naval expansion at Sevastopol (founded 1783AD at Akhtiar, rising to 14,0k including naval ratings by 1815AD), Simferopol (founded 1784AD beside Aqmescit, 4,8k), Feodosia (Kaffa) and Evpatoria restored Taurida's total population to 370k by 1815AD [35][36].

Bessarabia Oblast (Region 18: 200k to 310k in 1811AD to 385k in 1815AD, +92,5%): Ceded by the Ottoman Empire at the Treaty of Bucharest (28 May 1812AD) just four weeks before Napoleon crossed the Niemen, the interfluve between the Prut, Dniester and Black Sea combined Moldavian boyar/freeholder uplands around Kishinev (Chisinau) and Orhei with the southern Budjak steppe (Bender, Akkerman, Izmail, Kiliya and Khotin) [37][52]. During the 1806-1812AD Russo-Ottoman War, Russian expulsion of the Budjak Nogai horde (~25k - 35k) briefly depressed Region 18 from 340k (1806AD) to 310k (1811AD); immediately after 1812AD, tax exemptions, freedom from serfdom and Trans-Danubian Bulgarian, Gagauz, Moldavian, Ukrainian and Warsaw-Duchy German colonist inflows lifted Bessarabia to 385k by 1815AD (+24,2% in four years), whilst the new oblast capital Kishinev more than doubled from 7,5k (1811AD) to 18,0k (1815AD) [6][37].

Heartland, Volga-Urals & Caucasus (Regions 19-33)

Across the Great Russian interior, Volga-Ural basin and North Caucasian frontier (Regions 19-33, 4 188 909 km^2), total population rose from 14 055k in 1721AD to 29 245k in 1815AD (+108,1%), shaped by the shift of the demographic centre of gravity southward and eastward out of the Non-Black-Earth forest core toward the Chernozem, Lower Volga, Ural foundries and Kuban-Terek lines [2][4][47]. Figure 4 and Table 4 trace the restructuring of the Empire's leading urban hierarchy across 1721-1815AD.

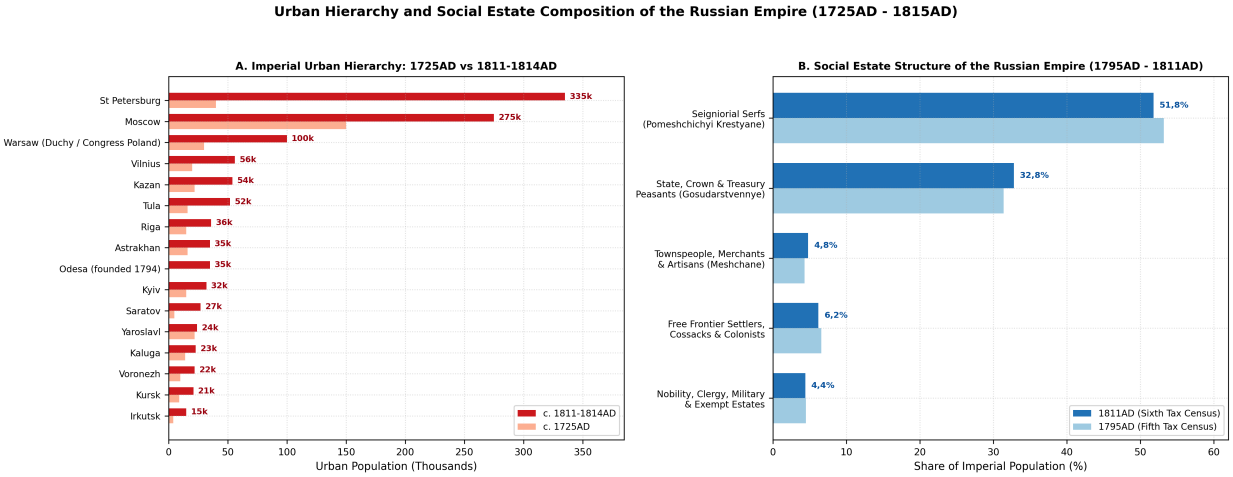


Figure 4. Largest cities in 1721AD and 1815AD (Panel A) and urban population trajectories of St Petersburg, Moscow, and regional ports (1721AD - 1815AD, Panel B).

Rank (1815)	City & Region	1721AD	1762AD	1795AD	1811AD	1815AD	Urban Function & Trajectory
No. 1	Saint Petersburg (Reg. 19)	40,0k	130,0k	225,0k	300,0k	335,0k	Imperial capital, court, Baltic port & guard garrisons (+737,5%)
No. 2	Moscow (Reg. 22)	140,0k	165,0k	215,0k	275,0k	185,0k	Old capital & textile hub; 1771 plague & Sep 1812 Fire (-32,7% vs 1811)
No. 3	Lviv / Lemberg (Reg. 10)	25,0k	30,0k	38,5k	43,0k	44,5k	Habsburg Galician crownland capital & commercial centre (+78,0%)
No. 4	Riga (Reg. 2)	11,8k	21,2k	30,8k	36,5k	36,0k	Baltic Livland capital & Daugava flax/timber port (+205,1%)
No. 5	Vilna / Vilnius (Reg. 6)	19,5k	26,0k	35,5k	42,0k	36,0k	Lithuanian capital & university; 1812 typhus/ retreat loss (-14,3% vs 1811)
No. 6	Astrakhan (Reg. 28)	15,0k	22,5k	30,0k	34,2k	35,2k	Caspian/Persian silk & Volga fisheries entrepot (+134,7%)
No. 7	Odessa (Reg. 16)	-	0,8k	4,5k	24,0k	35,0k	Founded 1794AD on Khadzhibey; Black Sea grain boomtown
No. 8	Kazan (Reg. 27)	18,0k	24,5k	29,5k	33,4k	34,2k	Middle Volga administrative, leather/soap & university (1804) hub
No. 9	Tula (Reg. 25)	16,0k	22,0k	28,0k	31,5k	32,5k	Imperial small-arms arsenal & iron/samovar workshops (+103,1%)
No. 10	Kronstadt (Reg. 19)	8,5k	16,5k	24,5k	29,5k	31,0k	Baltic Fleet island fortress & merchant customs roadstead

(Continued from previous page)

Rank (1815)	City & Region	1721AD	1762AD	1795AD	1811AD	1815AD	Urban Function & Trajectory
No. 11	Saratov (Reg. 28)	8,0k	13,5k	21,5k	26,0k	27,4k	Lower Volga salt/grain port & 1764 Volga German colony centre
No. 12	Yaroslavl (Reg. 24)	16,0k	19,0k	22,2k	24,0k	24,4k	Upper Volga linen manufactories & river transshipment (+52,5%)
No. 13	Kyiv (Reg. 12)	14,8k	18,2k	20,9k	22,6k	23,4k	Dnieper pilgrimage metropolis & Contract Fair (from 1797AD)
No. 14	Kaluga (Reg. 23)	12,8k	16,5k	20,8k	23,6k	23,0k	Oka grain/hemp river port & 1812 Russian rear depot (+79,7%)
No. 15	Oryol (Reg. 25)	9,5k	13,8k	18,8k	21,8k	22,5k	Oka head-of-navigation grain shipper to St Petersburg (+136,8%)
No. 16	Kursk (Reg. 26)	10,2k	14,5k	18,5k	20,7k	21,4k	Black-Earth guberniya seat & Korennaya Fair (+109,8%)
No. 17	Voronezh (Reg. 26)	11,0k	14,0k	17,5k	19,6k	20,2k	Don shipyard cradle & southern chernozem market (+83,6%)
No. 18	Kishinev (Reg. 18)	4,5k	6,0k	7,8k	7,5k	18,0k	Bessarabia Oblast capital after May 1812 annexation (+300,0%)

Table 4. Leading Urban Centres across the 40 Period-Authentic Regions by 1815AD Population (1721AD - 1815AD).

Capitals, 1771AD Plague & Chernozem Shift (Regions 19-26)

Saint Petersburg Governorate and the Northern Canal Hinterland (Regions 19-21), founded in 1703AD and confirmed at Nystad (1721AD), Saint Petersburg Governorate (Region 19) grew by +192,3% from 260k (1721AD) to 760k (1815AD) [8][44]. Sustained by compulsory noble residence, the Baltic Fleet at Kronstadt (5k to 31,0k), compulsory preferential customs tariffs over Arkhangelsk and seasonal *otkhodniki* peasant migrants, Saint Petersburg city surged more than eightfold from 40k in 1721AD to 130k (1762AD), 225k (1795AD, overtaking Moscow as Russia's largest city), 300k (1811AD) and 335k in 1815AD [4][44]. Supplying the northern capital with interior grain, iron and naval timber drove canal engineering across Region 20 (Novgorod, Pskov and Olonets Governorates: 1 155k to 1 770k, +53,2%) - via the Vyshny Volochyok waterway, Ladoga bypass canals and the Tikhvin and Mariinsk systems completed in 1810-1811AD, alongside Charles Gascoigne's Alexandrovsky cannon foundry at Petrozavodsk (2k) - whilst Region 21 (Arkhangelsk and Vologda Governorates: 560k to 920k, +64,3%) grew slowly after Peter I's 1713-1722AD diversion of foreign trade from White Sea Arkhangelsk (0k to 11,8k, partially liberalised by Catherine II in 1762AD) [3][8].

Moscow Governorate, the 1771AD Bubonic Plague and Central Russia (Regions 22 and 24-26): Moscow Governorate (Region 22) rose from 725k (1721AD) to 885k (1762AD), before suffering the deadliest urban epidemic of eighteenth-century Europe: the Bubonic Plague of 1770-1772AD [57][58]. Introduced from the

Moldavian-Wallachian war theatre into Moscow's woollen cloth manufactories (*Sukonnyy dvor*) in late 1770AD, mortality peaked at over 800 - 1 000 deaths per day in August - September 1771AD, sparking the Plague Riot (*Chumnoy bunt*) of 15-17 September 1771AD and the murder of Archbishop Ambrosius at the Donskoy Monastery before Count Grigory Orlov enforced quarantines and extra-mural plague cemeteries [57][58]. Between 56k and 70k inhabitants perished in Moscow city (over a quarter of its winter population, and ~100k across Moscow Governorate and adjacent central *uezds*), depressing Region 22's growth between 1762AD (885k) and 1782AD (985k) before rural textile immigration lifted Moscow city to 275k and Moscow Governorate to 1 235k by 1811AD [44]. Across Region 24 (Central Non-Black-Earth Industrial Belt: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma and Nizhny Novgorod, 2 420k to 4 110k, +69,8%), podzolic soils and cash-quitrent (*obrok*) serfdom fostered proto-industrial linen, cotton-printing and metalworking villages (Yaroslavl 24,4k, Nizhny Novgorod 16,8k, Kostroma 10,8k, Shuia-Ivanovo, Pavlovo-on-Oka) [8][47]. Conversely, fertile chernozem soils and demesne corvée (*barshchina*) propelled much faster agrarian expansion across Region 25 (Northern Black-Earth: Tula, Ryazan and Oryol, 1 580k to 3 520k, +122,8%) - led by Tula (5k) and Oryol (5k) - and Region 26 (Southern Black-Earth: Kursk, Voronezh and Tambov, 1 510k to 4 120k, +172,8%), where Kursk (4k), Voronezh (2k), Tambov (6k) and Lipetsk anchored grain and livestock production [2][15].

The Patriotic War of 1812AD Shock (Regions 3, 6-9, 22-23)

Between 24 June and December 1812AD, Napoleon's ~610k *Grande Armée* invaded and retreated along the Niemen-Dvina-Dnieper-Moskva axis, inflicting an acute demographic shock visible directly between the Sixth Revision (1811AD) and Seventh Revision (1815AD) [6][42][59]:

Across the seven directly invaded western and central regions (Regions 3, 6, 7, 8, 9, 22 and 23), combined population fell by -727k between 1811AD (8 895k) and 1815AD (8 168k), representing a -8,2% net contraction (or roughly 900k - 1,1M total demographic deficit once four years of foregone natural increase and Empire-wide levy casualties from the >900k recruits and *opolchenie* militiamen raised in 1812-1814AD are included) [6][42]. Region 23 (Smolensk, Kaluga and Tver Governorates: 2 870k in 1811AD to 2 640k in 1815AD, -230k or -8,0%): Bearing the brunt of the August battle and burning of Smolensk (6k to 8,8k), Vyazma (8k to 6,2k), Dorogobuzh, Gzhatsk and the October battle of Maloyaroslavets in Kaluga Governorate, Smolensk Governorate alone lost over 160k - 190k inhabitants to flight, scorched-earth destruction and epidemic typhus [59].

Region 22 (Moscow Governorate: 1 235k in 1811AD to 1 120k in 1815AD, -115k or -9,3%): Following the Battle of Borodino (7 September 1812AD), mass civilian evacuation reduced Moscow's resident population below ~15k - 25k when French troops entered on 14 September, and the Fire of Moscow (14-18 September 1812AD) destroyed ~6 500 of the city's ~9 150 houses (over 70% of the built stock). By 1815AD, Moscow city stood at ~185,0k - still -90,0k (-32,7%) below its 1811AD pre-war peak of 275,0k [42][44].

Volga-Ural Frontier, Pugachev & Caucasus (Regions 27-33)

Middle and Lower Volga (Regions 27 and 28): Region 27 (Kazan, Simbirsk and Penza Governorates: 1 420k to 3 290k, +131,7%) integrated Russian landlord estates with Volga Tatar, Chuvash, Mordvin and Mari state peasants, including the Admiralty *lashmany* ship-timber cutters around Kazan (0k to 34,2k, seat of Kazan Imperial University from 1804AD), Simbirsk (2k) and Penza (2k) [9][60]. Southward in Region 28 (Saratov and Astrakhan Governorates: 480k to 1 580k, +229,2%), two opposite mass migrations collided within eight years. Under Catherine II's Foreign Colonist Manifestos of 4 December 1762AD and 22 July 1763AD, 27k - 30k German colonists from Hesse, the Palatinate and Württemberg settled between 1764AD and 1768AD in 104 *Bergseite* and *Wiesenseite* mother colonies around Saratov (0k to 27,4k), Katharinenstadt (Marxstadt), Pokrovskaya (Engels) and Sarepta (Moravian colony near Tsaritsyn, founded 1765AD);

benefiting from religious autonomy, tax holidays and perpetual military exemption, the Volga Germans multiplied through natural increase (CBR > 52 per 1 000) to ~62k by 1815AD [51][61]. Conversely, encroaching Russian settlement lines and restriction of khanate autonomy provoked Ubashi Khan's Kalmyk Exodus (*Torghutskiy ukhod* / *Pylnyy pokhod*) of 5 January 1771AD: roughly 31k - 33k kibitkas (~150k - 170k Kalmyks) on the eastern *Wiesenseite* bank of the Volga set out across the Kazakh steppe toward Qing Dzungaria (Ili), losing over half their people and herds to winter exposure, disease and Kazakh/Kyrgyz attacks en route (~70k - 75k survivors reaching Qing territory), whilst an unseasonable Volga thaw trapped ~11k - 13k tents (~55k Kalmyks) on the right bank in Astrakhan Governorate (Astrakhan 15,0k to 35,2k), whose autonomous Kalmyk Khanate Catherine II abolished in October 1771AD [62][63][64].

Ural Metallurgical Serfdom and the Pugachev Rebellion (Regions 32 and 33): Under Peter I's Berg-Collegium decrees (including the 1721AD *possessional* peasant law allowing merchants to buy whole villages permanently bound to factories) and Demidov-Stroganov expansion, Region 32 (Perm and Vyatka Governorates: 685k to 1 920k, +180,3%) became the world's No. 1 pig-iron exporter in the second half of the eighteenth century [8][65][66]. Over 210k state *pripisnye krestyane* ("ascribed peasants" compelled to cut charcoal timber and haul ore in lieu of poll tax) and *possessionnye* foundry workers clustered around Ekaterinburg (founded 1723AD, 11,2k in 1815AD), Nizhny Tagil (Demidov hub, 13,8k), Perm (8k), Nevyansk, Kungur, Solikamsk, Vyatka (5k) and the Izhevsk arms factory (founded 1760AD, converted to a major imperial musket arsenal in 1807AD, 9,5k) [65][66]. Southward in Region 33 (Orenburg Governorate and Bashkiria: 460k to 1 400k, +204,3%), the construction of the Orenburg Fortified Line from 1735-1743AD (Orenburg 10,8k, Ufa 8,4k, Chelyabinsk, Troitsk, Orsk, Sterlitamak and Uralsk) provoked repeated Bashkir uprisings (1735-1740AD and 1755AD) and culminated in Yemelyan Pugachev's Rebellion (September 1773AD - January 1775AD), which united Yaik (renamed Ural) Cossacks, Bashkirs under Salavat Yulaev, Ural *pripisnye* foundrymen, Old Believers and Volga serfs from Orenburg and Kazan down to Saratov and Tsaritsyn, burning over 60 Ural ironworks and killing ~25k - 40k combatants and civilians before subsequent state-peasant and landlord colonisation tripled Region 33's population by 1815AD [8][67].

Don Cossack Host, Caucasian Line and Highlanders (Regions 29, 30 and 31): Region 29 (Don Cossack Host Province: 180k to 680k, +277,8%) expanded rapidly through Cossack natural increase, fugitive Ukrainian/Russian peasant settlement (registered to Don *starshina* estates in 1796AD), Taganrog port (refounded 1769AD, 8,8k in 1815AD), Nakhichevan-on-Don (founded 1779AD by Crimean Armenians relocated alongside the Mariupol Greeks, 9,2k) and Ataman Matvei Platov's transfer of the Host capital from flood-prone Cherkassk to Novocherkassk in 1805AD (5k in 1815AD) [2][46]. Along the Azov-Mozdok Fortified Line constructed in 1777-1780AD (Region 30: Caucasian Governorate / Georgievsk, Stavropol and Kuban, 120k to 505k, +320,8%), garrison towns at Kizlyar (founded 1735AD, Armenian/Georgian/Russian Caspian silk hub, 9,2k), Mozdok (1763AD), Georgievsk (1777AD, provincial seat from 1802AD) and Stavropol (1777AD, 5,5k) were joined in 1792-1793AD by Catherine II's resettlement of ~25k former Zaporozhian Black Sea Cossacks to the right bank of the Kuban River around Ekaterinodar (Krasnodar, founded 1793AD, 4,8k) [46][68]. South of the Kuban and Terek rivers, Region 31 (North Caucasian Highlanders: Circassia/Adygea, Kabarda, Chechnya and Dagestan Khanates, 780k to 910k, +16,7%) remained overwhelmingly outside imperial administration (apart from Vladikavkaz fort at the Darial Gorge, founded 1784AD, and Caspian Derbent, briefly occupied in 1722-1735AD and 1796AD before permanent annexation in 1806AD and Gulistan 1813AD, 9,5k), with recurrent plague outbreaks (1804-1812AD in Kabarda) and Sheikh Mansur's 1785-1791AD frontier war restraining net highland growth [5][40].

Siberia and the North Pacific (Regions 34-40)

Spanning 12 855 030 km^2 (69,5% of the 40-region land area), Eighteenth-Century Siberia and the North Pacific (Regions 34-40) doubled in population from 839k in 1721AD to 1 686k in 1815AD (+101,0%), shifting decisively from a seventeenth-century northern fur-tribute (*yasak*) colony into an agricultural, silver-mining and overland China-trade corridor along its southern forest-steppe belt [5][38][69]:

Western Siberian *Trakt*, Fortified Lines and Northern *Yasak* Basin (Regions 34 and 35): As routing shifted south from the old Verkhoturye-Tobolsk river portage to the Great Moscow-Siberian Post *Trakt* via Ekaterinburg-Tyumen-Ishim-Omsk-Kainsk-Tomsk (1730s-1760s), protected against Kazakh raids by the Ishim and Irtysh Fortified Lines (Omsk founded 1716AD, 6,8k in 1815AD; Petropavlovsk 1752AD), Region 34 (Southern Tobolsk: Tyumen, Kurgan, Ishim, Tara and Omsk) grew by +153,5% from 215k (1721AD) to 545k (1815AD), driven by free state-peasant (*gosudarstvennye krestyane*), Old Believer and exile settlement (Tyumen 8,6k) [39][69]. By contrast, Region 35 (Northern Tobolsk and Narym Ob-Irtysh Taiga/Tundra) grew more modestly (+88,2%, 85k to 160k), with historic Tobolsk (5k to 15,8k) gradually losing commercial primacy to southern *Trakt* towns alongside Khanty, Mansi, Nenets and Selkup *yasak* districts around Berezov, Surgut, Obdorsk and Narym [38][39].

Tomsk, Kolyvan-Voskresensk Altai Cabinet Silver Mines and the Sayan Border (Regions 36 and 37): The fastest growth anywhere in Asian Russia occurred in Region 36 (Tomsk Governorate, separated from Tobolsk in 1804AD, and the Kolyvan-Voskresensk Altai Mining District: 95k to 300k, +215,8%) [69][70]. Founded as Akinfiy Demidov's copper works in the 1720s and taken over in 1747AD by the Cabinet of Her Imperial Majesty after rich silver-bearing ores were discovered at Zmeinogorsk (2k), the Altai silver smelters around Barnaul (founded 1730s, 7,8k in 1815AD, where Ivan Polzunov built Russia's first industrial steam engine in 1763-1766AD) produced the bulk of Imperial Russia's domestic silver coinage, supported by >85k ascribed peasant households alongside Tomsk (2k), Kuznetsk, Biysk and Semipalatinsk [8][70]. Along the mountainous Qing frontier following the 1755-1758AD Qing destruction of the Dzungar Khanate, Region 37 (Altai-Sayan and Minusinsk Borderlands: 75k to 125k, +66,7%) integrated Southern Altai *dvoedantsy* ("double tribute-payers") and Khakas/Minusinsk steppe communities under the 1763AD Shcherbachev *yasak* commission [38][71].

Yeniseisk, Irkutsk-Transbaikalia Kiakhta Trade and the Kamchatka Smallpox Shock (Regions 38, 39 and 40): In Central Siberia, Region 38 (Yeniseisk Province: 72k to 144k, +100,0%) doubled along the Krasnoyarsk (8k) and Achinsk *Trakt* corridor whilst northern Yeniseisk (6k) and polar Turukhansk stagnated as sable stocks declined [69]. Eastward in Region 39 (Irkutsk Governorate and Transbaikalia: 142k to 252k, +77,5%), the Treaty of Kiakhta (August 1727AD) fixed the Russo-Qing border and funnelled official Sino-Russian tea, rhubarb, cotton and Siberian-Alaskan fur trade through Kiakhta / Troitskosavsk (8k), transforming Irkutsk (5k to 14,5k) into the wealthy administrative and Russian-American Company headquarters of Eastern Siberia, alongside Buryat steppe *datsans* around Selenginsk and Verkhneudinsk (8k) and the Cabinet silver-lead *katorga* mines at Nerchinsk (2k) [38][69]. Finally, across the immense 5 297 950 km^2 subarctic and maritime expanse of Region 40 (Yakutsk, Okhotsk Seaboard and Kamchatka Oblast: 155k in 1721AD to 115k in 1744AD to 160k in 1815AD, +3,2%), cattle-herding Yakuts (Sakha) around Yakutsk (0k) proved demographically resilient (recovering to >110k by 1815AD), whereas Yukaghir, Chukchi, Koryak and Itelmen communities suffered devastating virgin-soil epidemics and frontier warfare during the decades of Vitus Bering's First (1725-1730AD) and Second (1733-1743AD) Kamchatka Expeditions out of Okhotsk (4k) and Petropavlovsk-Kamchatsky (founded October 1740AD) [38][72]. Above all, the 1768-1769AD Kamchatka smallpox pandemic killed ~5 000 - 6 000 indigenous inhabitants - wiping out more than half to two-thirds of the surviving Itelmen (*Kamchadal*) population - leaving the entire Far Northeastern domain barely above its 1721AD headcount by 1815AD [72][73].

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